

Operating Systems

Project Checkpoint 5

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1 Part 1

1.1 Compilation

```
boanz@BENSONCH /cygdrive/d/os/ppc5_1
$ make clean
rm *.hex *.ihx *.lnk *.lst *.map *.mem *.rel *.rst *.sym *.asm *.lk
rm: cannot remove '*.hex': No such file or directory
rm: cannot remove '*.ihx': No such file or directory
rm: cannot remove '*.lnk': No such file or directory
rm: cannot remove '*.lst': No such file or directory
rm: cannot remove '*.map': No such file or directory
rm: cannot remove '*.mem': No such file or directory
rm: cannot remove '*.rel': No such file or directory
rm: cannot remove '*.rst': No such file or directory
rm: cannot remove '*.sym': No such file or directory
rm: cannot remove '*.asm': No such file or directory
rm: cannot remove '*.lk': No such file or directory
make: *** [Makefile:18: clean] Error 1

boanz@BENSONCH /cygdrive/d/os/ppc5_1
$ make
sdcc -c --model-small testlcd.c
sdcc -c --model-small preemptive.c
preemptive.c:149: warning 85: in function ThreadCreate unreferenced function arg
ument : 'fp'
preemptive.c:190: warning 158: overflow in implicit constant conversion
sdcc -c --model-small lcdlib.c
lcdlib.c:76: warning 85: in function delay unreferenced function argument : 'n'
sdcc -c --model-small buttonlib.c
sdcc -c --model-small keylib.c
sdcc -o testlcd.hex testlcd.rel preemptive.rel lcdlib.rel buttonlib.rel keylib.
rel
```

Figure 1: make clean and make for Part 1

1.2 Address List

	value	Global	Global Defined In Module
	-----	-----	-----
C:	00000081	_Producer1	testlcd
C:	000000D5	_Producer2	testlcd
C:	00000129	_Consumer	testlcd
C:	0000016B	_main	testlcd
C:	0000018C	__sdcc_gsinit_startup	testlcd
C:	00000190	__mcs51_genRAMCLEAR	testlcd
C:	00000191	__mcs51_genXINIT	testlcd
C:	00000192	__mcs51_genXRAMCLEAR	testlcd
C:	00000193	_timer0_ISR	testlcd
C:	00000199	_Bootstrap	preemptive
C:	000001C2	_myTimer0Handler	preemptive
C:	0000024B	_ThreadCreate	preemptive
C:	000002BE	_ThreadYield	preemptive
C:	00000312	_ThreadExit	preemptive
C:	0000036F	_LCD_ready	lcdlib
C:	00000373	_LCD_Init	lcdlib
C:	00000386	_LCD_IRwrite	lcdlib
C:	000003A8	_LCD_functionSet	lcdlib
C:	000003D2	_LCD_write_char	lcdlib
C:	000003FC	_LCD_write_string	lcdlib
C:	00000431	_delay	lcdlib
C:	00000435	_AnyButtonPressed	buttonlib
C:	00000447	_ButtonToChar	buttonlib
C:	000004D3	_Init_Keypad	keylib
C:	000004D9	_AnyKeyPressed	keylib
C:	000004E6	_KeyToChar	keylib
C:	00000562	__gpctrget	_gpctrget

Figure 2: Function address list for Part 1

1.3 Producer 1 (Button Bank)

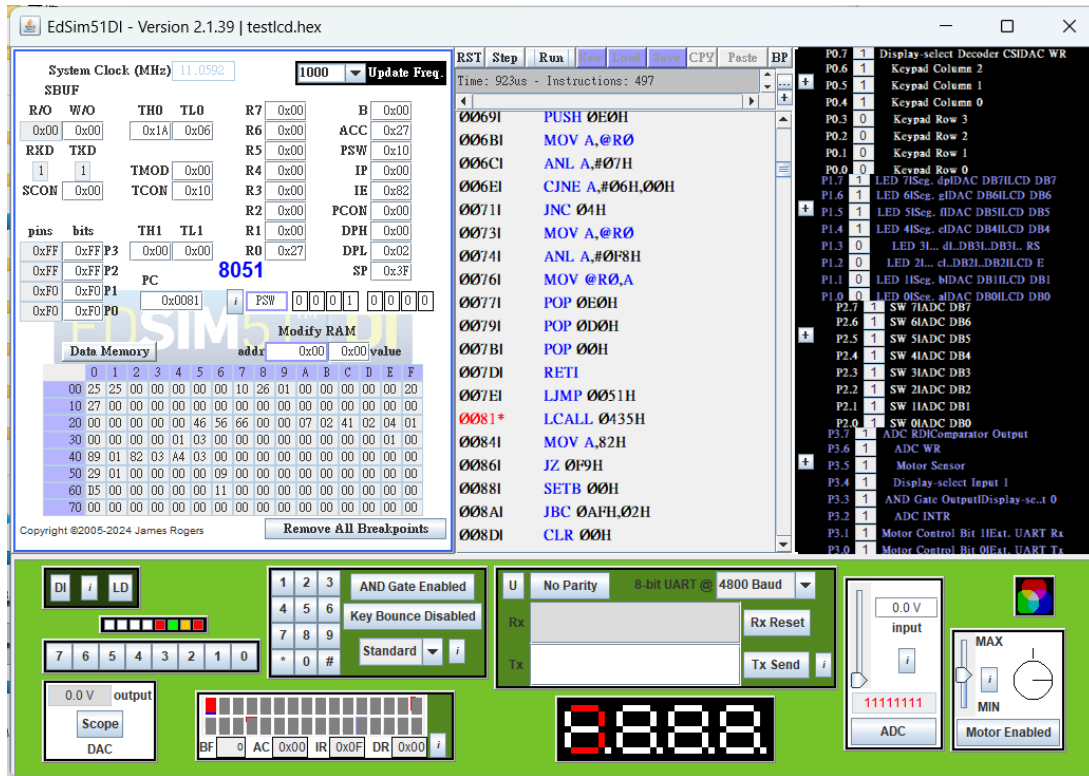


Figure 3: Screenshot for the first `Producer1` call

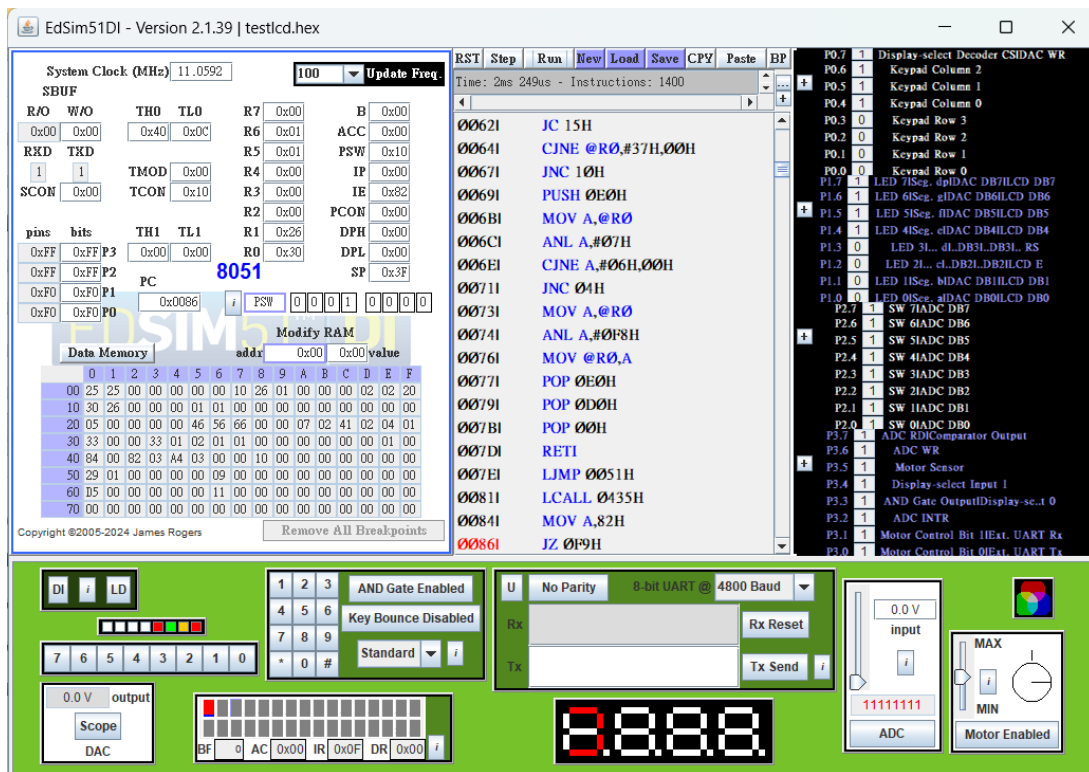


Figure 4: Screenshot after pressing button 3 in `Producer1`

The `Producer1` function reads from the button bank (port P2). Its code starts at address 0x0081. It busy-waits on `AnyButtonPressed` until a button is pressed, then reads the button value via `ButtonToChar` inside a critical section to prevent a race condition with the timer interrupt. The ASCII value is enqueued into the shared ring buffer at 0x30--0x32 after acquiring the `empty` and `mutex` semaphores. After signalling `mutex` and `full`, it waits for the button to be released before the next read. In the example above, button 3 was pressed, so 0x33 (ASCII '3') was written to `buffer[0]` at address 0x30.

1.4 Producer 2 (Keypad)

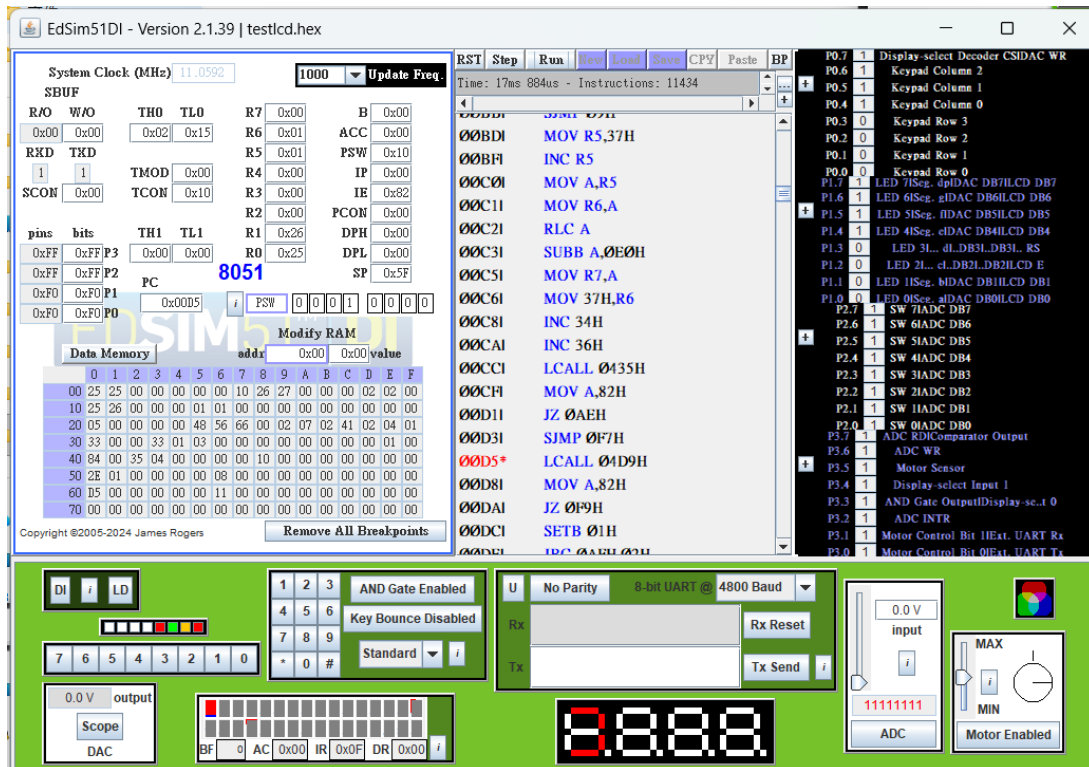


Figure 5: Screenshot for the first `Producer2` call

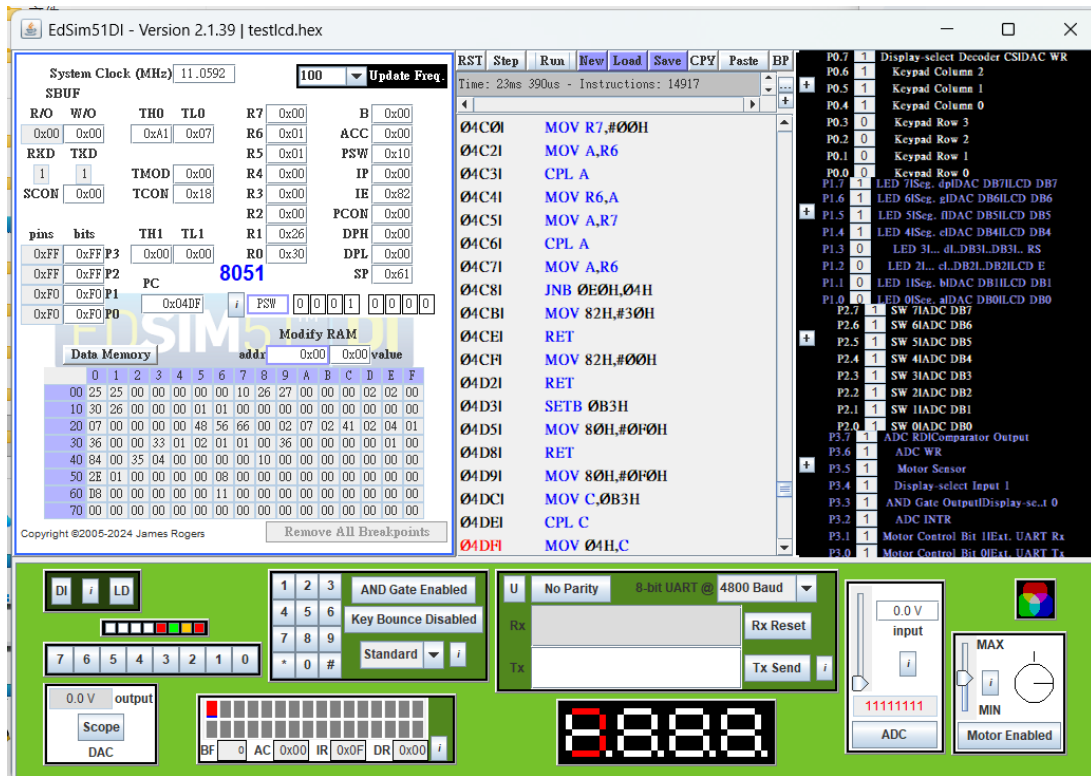


Figure 6: Screenshot after pressing keypad key 6 in [Producer2](#)

The [Producer2](#) function reads from the 3×4 matrix keypad. Its code starts at address 0x00D5. The structure is identical to [Producer1](#): the keypad is scanned row by row via [KeyToChar](#), with [AnyKeyPressed](#) using the AND-gate output on P3.3 for a quick any-key detection. The ASCII value is enqueued into the shared buffer under semaphore protection, and the function waits for the key to be released before proceeding. In the example above, keypad key 6 was pressed, so 0x36 (ASCII '6') was written to `buffer[0]` at address 0x30.

1.5 Consumer (LCD)

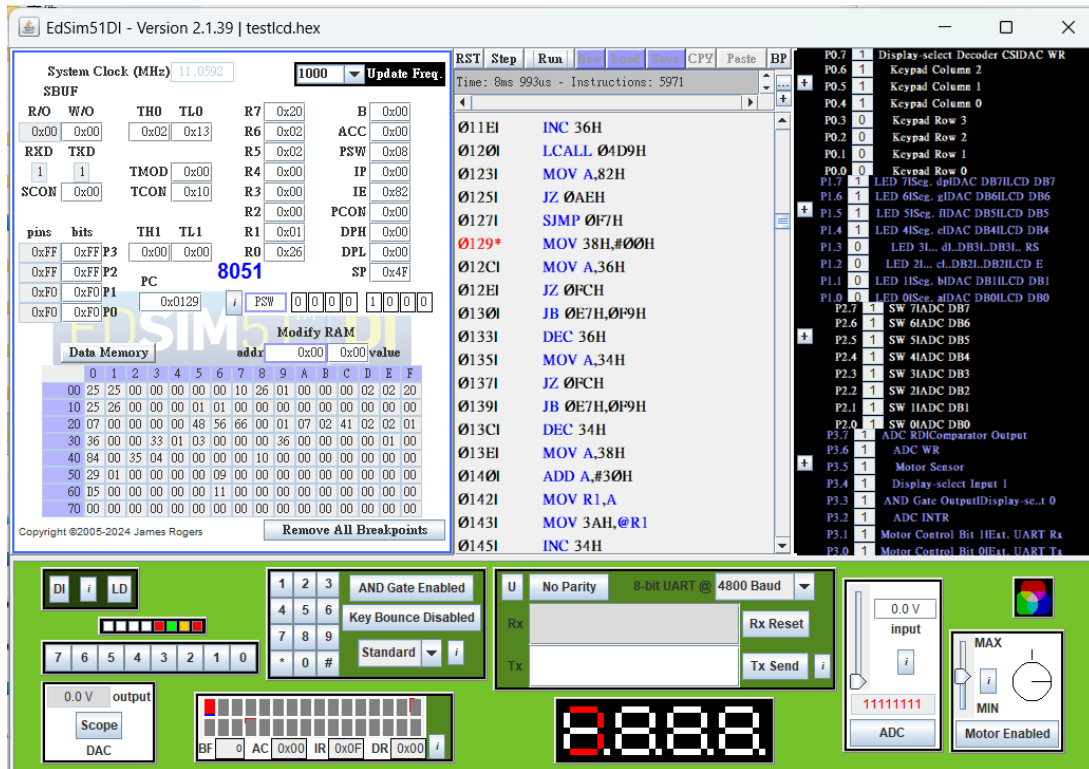


Figure 7: Screenshot for the first [Consumer](#) call

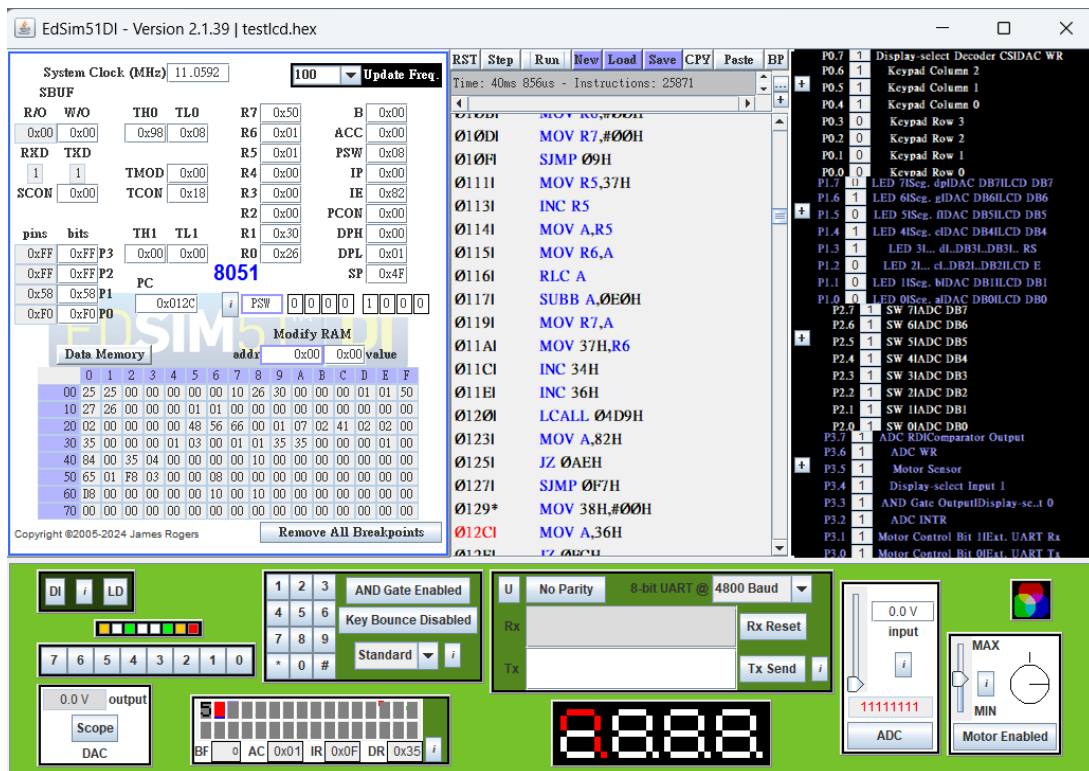


Figure 8: Screenshot of the LCD displaying character '5'

The `Consumer` function's code starts at address `0x0129`. It dequeues one character at a time from the shared ring buffer under semaphore protection, then writes it to the LCD via `LCD_write_char`. After each write it busy-waits on `LCD_ready` before issuing the next character, because the HD44780 controller requires a settling delay between consecutive writes. In the example above, keypad key 5 was pressed, so `0x35` (ASCII '5') was enqueued and subsequently displayed on the LCD. The LCD Data Register (DR) confirms the value `0x35` was correctly transmitted to the display.

2 Part 2

2.1 Compilation

```
boanz@BENSONCH /cygdrive/d/os/ppc5_2
$ make clean
rm *.hex *.ihx *.lnk *.lst *.map *.mem *.rel *.rst *.sym *.asm *.lk
rm: cannot remove '*.ihx': No such file or directory
rm: cannot remove '*.lnk': No such file or directory
make: *** [Makefile:16: clean] Error 1

boanz@BENSONCH /cygdrive/d/os/ppc5_2
$ make
sdcc -c --model-small dino.c
sdcc -c --model-small preemptive.c
preemptive.c:240: warning 85: in function ThreadCreate unreferenced function argument : 'fp'
preemptive.c:333: warning 158: overflow in implicit constant conversion
sdcc -c --model-small lcdlib.c
lcdlib.c:80: warning 85: in function delay unreferenced function argument : 'n'
sdcc -c --model-small keylib.c
sdcc -o dino.hex dino.rel preemptive.rel lcdlib.rel keylib.rel
```

Figure 9: `make clean` and `make` for Part 2

2.2 Address List

	value	Global	Global Defined In Module
C:	00000081	_render_task	dino
C:	000001B6	_keypad_ctrl	dino
C:	00000237	_game_ctrl	dino
C:	00000319	_main	dino
C:	0000039B	__sdcc_gsinit_startup	dino
C:	0000039F	__mcs51_genRAMCLEAR	dino
C:	000003A0	__mcs51_genXINIT	dino
C:	000003A1	__mcs51_genXRAMCLEAR	dino
C:	000003A2	_timer0_ISR	dino
C:	000003A8	_Bootstrap	preemptive
C:	000003C6	_myTimer0Handler	preemptive
C:	00000422	_ThreadCreate	preemptive
C:	0000049C	_ThreadYield	preemptive
C:	000004F7	_ThreadExit	preemptive
C:	00000566	_ThreadReset	preemptive
C:	0000056A	_LCD_ready	lcdlib
C:	0000056E	_LCD_Init	lcdlib
C:	000005CF	_LCD_IRWrite	lcdlib
C:	000005F1	_LCD_functionSet	lcdlib
C:	0000061B	_LCD_write_char	lcdlib
C:	00000645	_LCD_write_string	lcdlib
C:	0000067A	_delay	lcdlib
C:	0000067E	_LCD_set_symbol	lcdlib
C:	0000078F	_Init_Keypad	keylib
C:	00000795	_AnyKeyPressed	keylib
C:	000007A2	_KeyToChar	keylib
C:	0000081E	__gptrget	_gptrget

Figure 10: Function address list for Part 2

2.3 Main Function

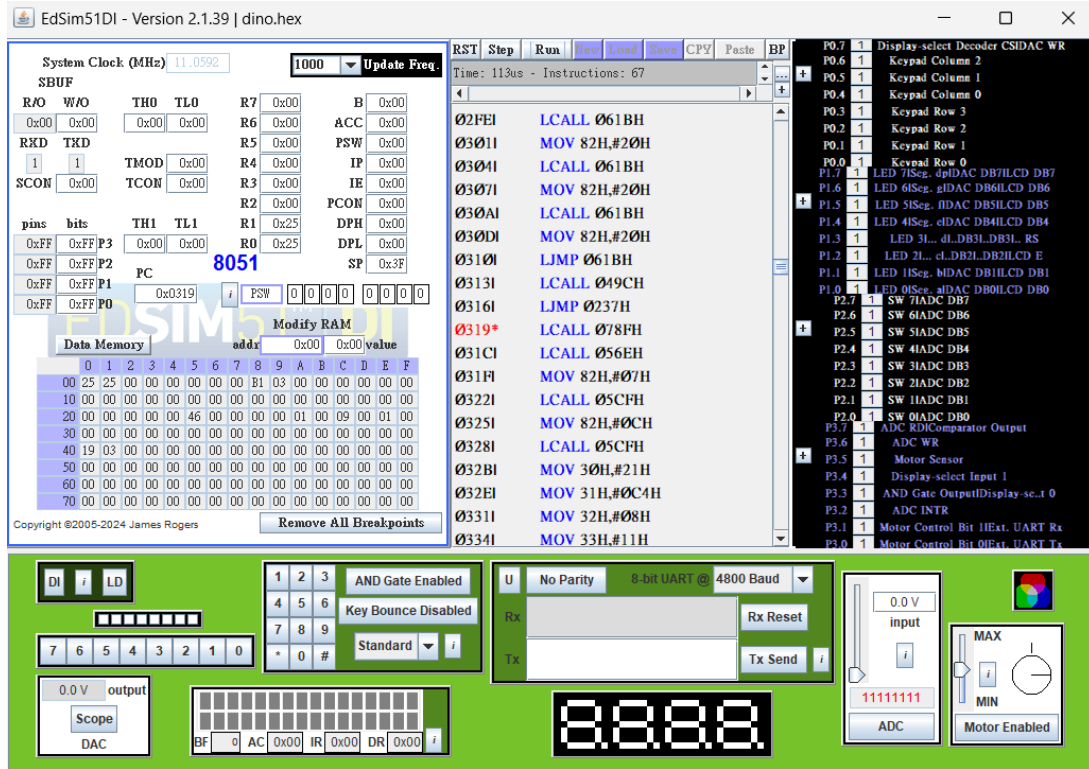


Figure 11: Screenshot for the first `main` call

The `main` function's code starts at address 0x0319. It first initialises the keypad and LCD, then enters an infinite loop that supports multiple rounds of play. At the start of each round, the cactus bitmaps (`row_top` and `row_bot`), score, difficulty level, and player position are all reset. The user is then prompted to enter a digit (1–9) followed by `#` to set the difficulty level; pressing `#` without a prior digit is ignored. After the difficulty is confirmed, `render_task` and `keypad_ctrl` are spawned as Thread 1 and Thread 2. Timer 0 is configured in mode 0 with `TH0 = (level << 4)`, so a higher difficulty produces a faster overflow and more frequent context switches, making the cacti scroll faster. `game_ctrl` is then called directly in Thread 0. When `game_ctrl` returns after a collision, interrupts are disabled and `ThreadReset` kills Threads 1 and 2, leaving only Thread 0 alive to start the next round.

2.4 Render Task Thread

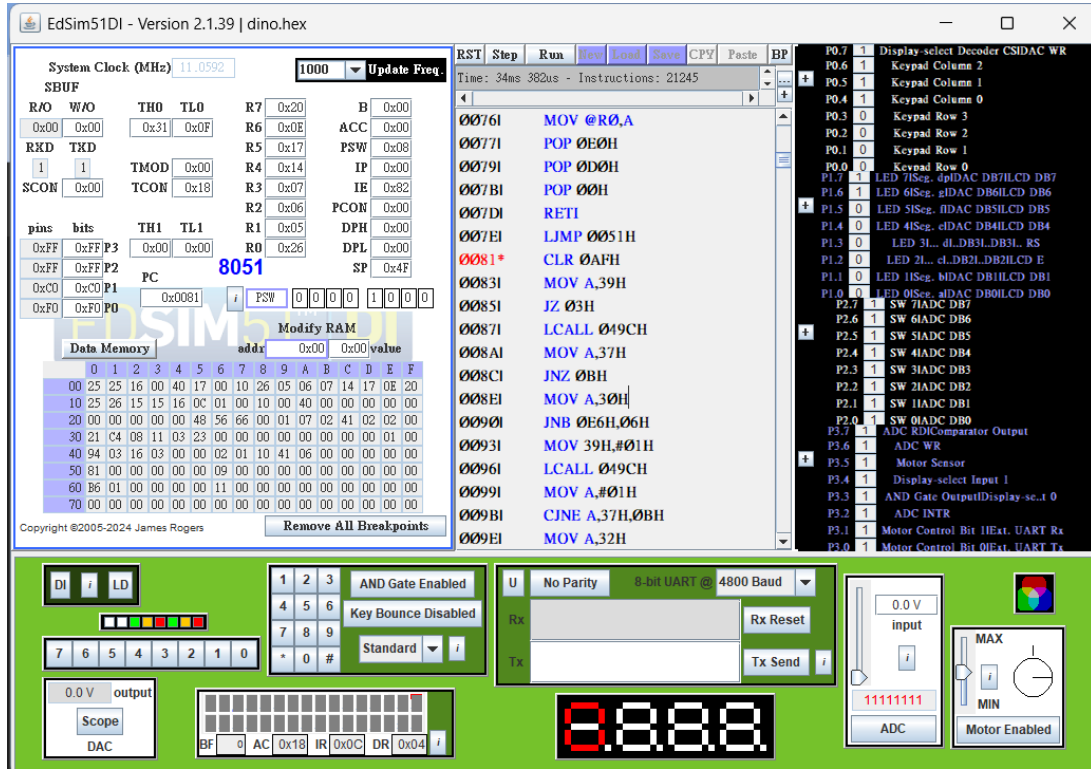


Figure 12: Screenshot for the first `render_task` call

The `render_task` function's code starts at address 0x0081. It runs as an infinite loop and is responsible for updating the LCD every frame. At the start of each frame, interrupts are disabled (`EA = 0`) and the function checks whether `gameover` is set; if so, it immediately yields without drawing. It then checks for a collision at column 1 (bit 0x40 of `row_top[0]` or `row_bot[0]`), since that is the column the player occupies after the next shift. If a collision is detected, `gameover` is set to 1 and the thread yields.

Otherwise, both cactus bitmaps are shifted left by one bit. The most significant bit of each bitmap pair is saved as a carry flag before the shift; if a cactus exits the left edge, it means the player successfully dodged it, so the score is incremented and the cactus is reinserted at the rightmost column (bit 0 of `row_top[1]` or `row_bot[1]`).

After shifting, both rows are redrawn on the LCD using custom character '\2' for cacti and a space for empty columns. Finally, the player sprite ('\1') is written to column 0 of `dino_row`, and `ThreadYield` is called.

The cactus map is stored as four unsigned char variables (`row_top[0]`, `row_top[1]`, `row_bot[0]`, `row_bot[1]`), using one bit per column position. This requires only 4 bytes instead of 32, which is critical given the 8051's limited internal RAM.

2.5 Keypad Control Thread

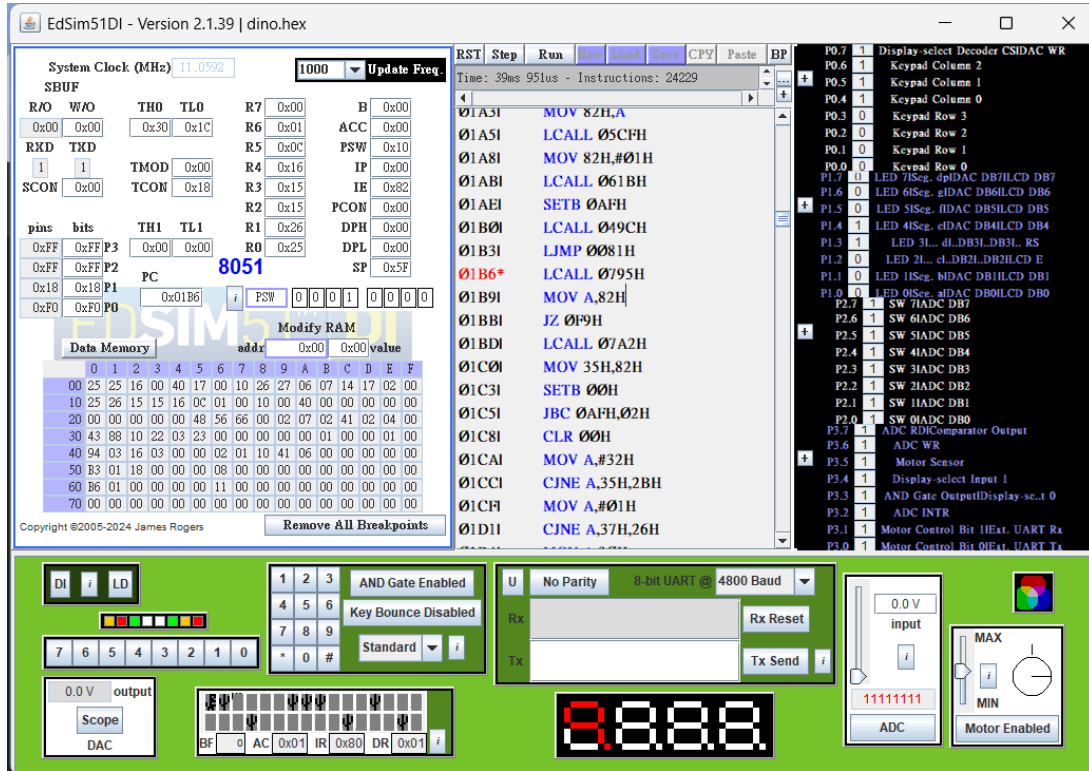


Figure 13: Screenshot for the first `keypad_ctrl` call

The `keypad_ctrl` function's code starts at address 0x01B6. It busy-waits on `AnyKeyPressed` until a key is held down, then reads the key with `KeyToChar`. The movement logic runs inside a `__critical` block to prevent the timer interrupt from firing mid-update and causing a race condition where two player sprites could appear simultaneously on the LCD.

Pressing '2' moves the player from row 1 to row 0 (upward). Pressing '8' moves the player from row 0 to row 1 (downward). Before moving, the function checks bit 0x80 of the destination row's bitmap (column 0); if a cactus is already there, `gameover` is set and the thread yields immediately instead of moving. After a valid move, the old position is overwritten with a space and the new position is drawn with the player sprite. The function then busy-waits for the key to be released before reading the next input.

2.6 Game Control Thread

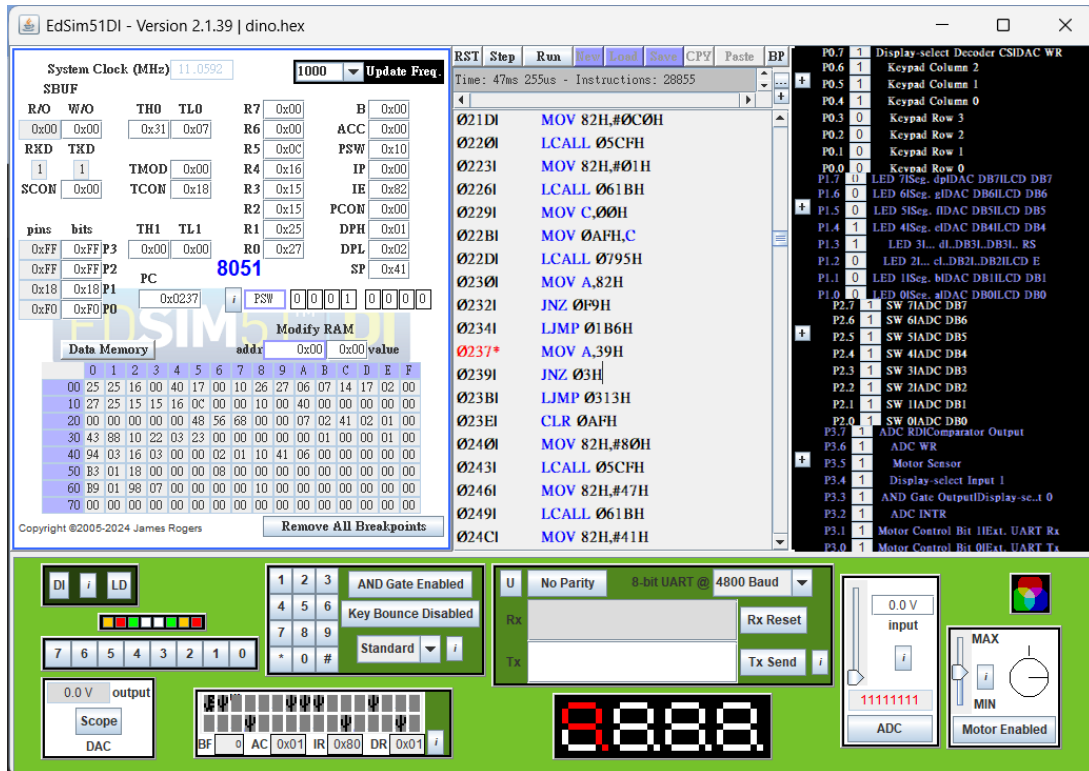


Figure 14: Screenshot for the first `game_ctrl` call

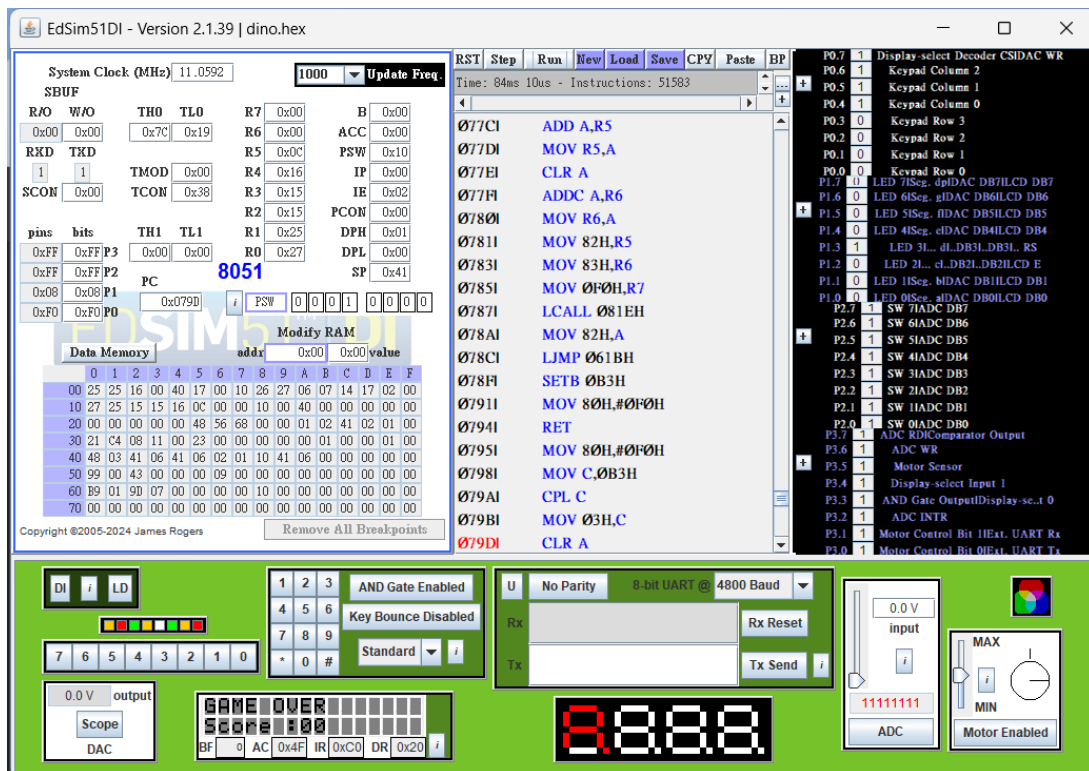


Figure 15: Screenshot of the LCD after the dinosaur collides with a cactus

The `game_ctrl` function's code starts at address `0x0237`. It shares Thread 0 with `main` and runs as an infinite loop that simply calls `ThreadYield` until `gameover` becomes 1. Once a collision is detected, interrupts are disabled and the LCD is overwritten with `GAME OVER` on the first row and the score in decimal on the second row. The score is displayed as two digits using integer division and modulo. After writing the game-over screen, the function returns to `main`, which resets the thread mask and restarts the game loop.

Q1: What data type do you use for the map?

The map is stored as four `unsigned char` variables: `row_top[0]`, `row_top[1]`, `row_bot[0]`, and `row_bot[1]`. Each pair represents one LCD row as a 16-bit bitmap where each bit corresponds to one column. This requires only 4 bytes instead of 32, which is essential given the 8051's limited internal RAM.

Q2: How do you generate a new cactus?

A predefined starting map is used. Each frame `render_task` performs a circular left shift: a cactus that exits the left edge is reinserted at the rightmost column. The initial values are chosen to avoid vertical or diagonal walls, so the pattern remains valid indefinitely.

2.7 Race Condition

The primary race condition occurs in `keypad_ctrl`. If the timer interrupt fires between reading `AnyKeyPressed` and updating `dino_row` and the LCD, `render_task` could redraw the old player position while `keypad_ctrl` is writing the new one, resulting in two player sprites on screen simultaneously. This is resolved by wrapping the movement update in a `__critical` block, which disables interrupts for the duration of the LCD write and position update.